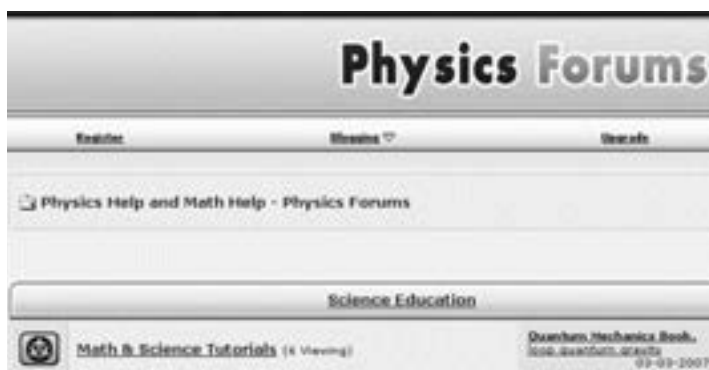




The Physics Forums homepage

one dedicated to Homework / Classwork questions where students can seek answers to queries. There is another section on tutorials, where one can find links to sites offering educational tools. Besides these is the usual forum where people can discuss physics problems. A link on the top of the site, labelled “Links”, offers access to other information-laden sites on various subjects. While some of the links offer free e-books on the subject and cater to the physics student, there are others that offer research documents for download—like the link to Cornell University Library (arxiv.org) offering free access to about 4 lakh e-papers on various subjects.

This is a very lively site that seems to be frequented by, based on the user profiles, all types of physics lovers—students, teachers, physicists, etc. The forum is well-moderated, with questions in the wrong forum being moved to the proper ones, and unwanted posts deleted promptly. As is standard practice at most forums, only registered users are allowed to post or reply on the forum, while anyone can read through the posts. Unregistered members also do not have access to a site-wide search tool which would help in finding whether a query has been previously answered. Unregistered users are only allowed to search within a thread, which may not be of much practical use.

The site offers paid memberships, which increase the features of the site available to the user. While a comprehensive feature list